

# Composition Pair 17: Population Participation Governance and Exit Rights

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## Attribution

This work derives from and formalizes the inter-Self coordination architecture introduced in "Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration" (Li, April 2026), the third paper in the CKS theory series following "Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems" (Li, April 2026) and "The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model" (Li, April 2026).

## Abstract

Two governance commitments from the population-scale CKS architecture — a Self's right to configure its own network participation posture (D2.31) and a Self's right to exit coordination relationships (D2.46) — interact in ways that neither commitment addresses individually. This note formalizes three non-obvious requirements that emerge when both commitments operate simultaneously during governance offboarding: (1) the participation configuration update must precede or accompany individual exit executions, because the configuration functions as an active invitation signal to the network; (2) a portfolio-scale exit requires a dedicated coordination record that neither commitment alone mandates; and (3) after exit completion, the participation configuration must accurately reflect actual outcomes rather than merely intended ones — a population-topology accuracy obligation that the D2.31 calibrated-humility register extends at scale. The operational test asks whether an observer can verify each requirement from the governance record alone.

## 1. Pair Identification

**Commitment A — Population-Scope Participation Governance (D2.31, Claim 6 territory):** A Self configures its network role, propagation permissions, partner preferences, and participation posture in the population-scale coordination network. This configuration is substrate content per Claim 5; it is authored and updated under the Self's home governance authority. Because it operates at Claim 6's population scope, this commitment is formalized in the calibrated-humility register — the architectural commitment is clear, while the full dynamics of population-scale participation await empirical observation.

**Commitment B — Exit Rights (D2.46):** A Self's governance right to terminate coordination relationships, including active exchange events and standing configurations. Exit is exercised individually, per relationship, with each exercise generating a governance record that documents the termination event and its effective date.

The pair becomes active during *governance offboarding* (D2.70): a Self decides to substantially reduce or terminate its participation in the population-scale network. The offboarding requires both updating the network participation configuration (Commitment A) and exercising exit rights across each existing coordination relationship (Commitment B). The interaction between these two commitments generates requirements that neither commitment, applied alone, produces.

## 2. The Governance Scenario

A Self operating in the population-scale network has, over time, accumulated a portfolio of active coordination relationships with multiple partner Selves. Its participation configuration — the substrate content governing its network role, propagation permissions, and partner preferences — reflects full openness: broad propagation permissions, no partner exclusions, and an active network role.

The Self's governing humans decide to substantially reduce network participation. The governance decision is made and recorded. The Self now faces a compound task: it must exercise exit rights (D2.46) across each existing coordination relationship in its portfolio, and it must update its participation configuration (D2.31) to reflect its reduced posture. The question that exposes the composition is: *in what order, and with what governance artifacts?* Neither commitment specifies this.

## 3. Non-Obvious Governance Requirements

**Requirement 1 — Participation configuration update must precede or accompany exit execution.**

The participation configuration is not merely a record of current relationships. It is an *active signal* to the population-scale network. Other Selves whose partner-preference rules scan the network for coordination opportunities read participation configurations as invitations: a configuration showing open partner preferences and broad propagation permissions tells the network that the Self is available for new coordination relationships.

When a Self begins executing exit rights across its existing portfolio, the governance process takes time. Exit governance is exercised one relationship at a time, each exercise requiring documentation and effective-date recording. During the interval between the first exit and the last, the Self's participation configuration may still show full openness — because no one has yet updated it. In this window, new relationship invitations may arrive from Selves elsewhere in the network who read the still-open configuration and identify a match.

If a new coordination relationship forms during exit execution, the offboarding process becomes self-defeating: the Self must then govern exits from newly formed relationships while completing exits from existing ones. More fundamentally, the new relationships form under a configuration that no longer reflects the Self's governance intentions.

The composition requirement is therefore: the participation configuration update — reflecting reduced or terminated partner preferences and restricted propagation permissions — must be recorded as substrate content *before* or *concurrently* with the initiation of individual exit governance. This ordering requirement is generated by the interaction of D2.31 (the configuration as an active network signal) with D2.46 (exit governance as a process that takes time to complete). Neither commitment alone generates the sequencing rule.

**Requirement 2 — Portfolio-scale exit requires a governance coordination record.**

D2.46 governs the exit of individual relationships: one record per exit, documenting the specific relationship, the termination event, and the effective date. D2.31 governs the participation configuration: a substrate content update reflecting the Self's revised participation posture. Neither commitment produces a governance artifact that spans the portfolio of exits as a unified governance act.

When a Self exits multiple relationships simultaneously — governance offboarding at portfolio scale — the individual exit records document each termination but do not collectively document the portfolio-level decision: which relationships are being exited, in what sequence, what the updated participation configuration is, and the governance reasoning for the portfolio-wide change. This documentation gap is practically significant. A governing human reviewing the record after the fact can read each individual exit, but without a coordination record the portfolio-level intent and scope cannot be verified from the substrate alone.

The composition therefore requires a *portfolio-scale exit coordination record* as a distinct governance artifact. This record is substrate content that: (a) identifies the full set of relationships being exited; (b) specifies the sequence of exit execution; (c) references the updated participation configuration; and (d) records the governance reasoning for the portfolio-wide decision. The artifact is generated by the simultaneous application of D2.31 and D2.46 at portfolio scale; it does not exist in either commitment individually.

**Requirement 3 — Participation configuration must accurately reflect completed exits (calibrated-humility register).**

This requirement operates in the calibrated-humility register appropriate to Claim 6 territory, because it depends on dynamics at population scale that the architecture commits to without being able to fully specify in advance.

At population scale, the participation configurations of individual Selves contribute to the *perceived network topology* — the collective picture of network structure that other Selves' governance systems read when identifying coordination opportunities, routing propagation, and assessing partner preferences (D2.61). Each Self's participation configuration is one data point in the aggregate topology that other Selves perceive.

If a Self has completed exits — individual relationships have been terminated and exit records exist — but has not updated its participation configuration to reflect those completed exits, a gap exists between the actual topology and the perceived topology. Other Selves reading the still-stale configuration may perceive a coordination surface that no longer exists. At scale, many Selves with stale post-exit configurations generate systematic inaccuracy in the perceived topology.

The composition requirement, formalized in calibrated-humility register: the participation configuration must be updated to reflect *completed* exits, not merely *intended* exits. The update obligation is triggered by exit completion, not by the governance decision to exit. This population-topology accuracy requirement emerges from the joint operation of D2.31 (the configuration as network-visible substrate content) and D2.46 (the exit as a completed governance act with an effective date) at Claim 6's scale. The precise dynamics — how quickly stale configurations propagate inaccuracy, how governance systems at scale detect and correct the gap — are empirical questions that the calibrated-humility framing honestly acknowledges. The architectural commitment to the accuracy obligation is clear.

#### **4. Prior-Art Significance**

The three requirements formalized above are specific to this composition and are not separately derivable from D2.31 or D2.46 alone.

The *ordering requirement* (Requirement 1) — that participation configuration update must precede or accompany exit execution because the configuration functions as an active network signal — is not a general property of governed exit frameworks and is not generated by participation governance standing alone. It requires both commitments operating together during an offboarding event. A withdrawal governance framework that governs individual exits without addressing the invitation-signal problem has not addressed the composition's primary sequencing obligation.

The *portfolio coordination record* (Requirement 2) — as a distinct substrate-content governance artifact spanning multiple exit exercises — is not a standard product of per-relationship exit governance or of configuration management individually. No amount of compliant individual exit documentation and no configuration update, taken separately, produces the portfolio-scoped artifact. The artifact is strictly a composition product.

The *population-topology accuracy obligation* (Requirement 3) — treating post-exit configuration accuracy as a governance obligation rather than a best-effort maintenance task — is generated by the intersection of individual-exit governance (D2.46) and the network-visible role of participation

configuration at population scope (D2.31 in Claim 6 territory). Calibrated-humility register is appropriate for this requirement because its architectural shape is clear while its full operational form at scale awaits empirical development.

Any governance framework claiming to address "governed network participant withdrawal" in a population-scale coordination architecture must address all three requirements. Frameworks that govern exit without addressing participation configuration sequencing, that document individual exits without portfolio-coordination records, or that treat post-exit configuration accuracy as discretionary are addressing a subset of the composition's governance territory.

## 5. Operational Test

For a Self conducting portfolio-scale exit governance, an observer reviewing the governance record should be able to verify:

**(a) Ordering:** The participation configuration update record — showing reduced or terminated partner preferences and propagation permissions — carries a timestamp that precedes or is contemporaneous with the earliest individual exit record in the portfolio. If the earliest individual exit record predates the configuration update record by a meaningful interval, Requirement 1 is not satisfied.

**(b) Portfolio coordination record:** A portfolio-scale exit coordination record exists in the substrate that identifies the full set of relationships being exited, specifies the exit sequence, references the updated participation configuration, and records the governance reasoning for the portfolio-wide decision. The record is distinct from the individual exit records it coordinates. If only individual exit records exist, without a spanning coordination artifact, Requirement 2 is not satisfied.

**(c) Post-completion accuracy:** The participation configuration in the substrate, after all exit records show completed status, accurately reflects the exits — it does not reference relationships that have been terminated, and its partner preference and propagation permission settings are consistent with the Self's post-offboarding participation posture. The configuration reflects completed exits, not only intended ones. If the configuration still references terminated relationships or retains settings inconsistent with the completed exits, Requirement 3 is not satisfied.

A governance record that satisfies (a)–(c) instantiates the composition's requirements. A record that satisfies D2.46's individual exit documentation and D2.31's configuration-as-substrate-content commitment, but fails any of (a), (b), or (c), partially satisfies the parent commitments without satisfying the requirements that emerge from their combination.

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## Source Papers

Li, W. (2026). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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